Food Cooling Log (2-hour / 6-hour rule)

Business: _____ **Week of:** _____ **Thermometer ID:** _____

Stage 1: 135°F → 70°F (57°C → 21°C) within 2 hours · **Stage 2: 70°F → 41°F (21°C → 5°C) within the next 4 hours (6 h total)** — §3-501.14(A) · Ambient-temperature ingredients: to 41°F within 4 h — §3-501.14(B) · Missed stage 1? Reheat to 165°F and restart, or discard

Date	Food item	Cooling method	Start time	Start °F	1 h °F	2 h time	2 h °F (≤70)	4 h °F	6 h time	6 h °F (≤41)	Action / initials

Rules: FDA Food Code 2022 (same limits in the 2026 edition) §3-501.14, §3-501.15. Not legal advice; your local health department's rules apply and may be stricter.
Keep completed logs for as long as your health department requires - ask your inspector how long that is.

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